

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's *Reflections on:* **PRAYER,** **PROCLAMATION and** **PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.14. 29 April 2024



OUR THEME:

WORK OUT YOUR OWN SALVATION WITH FEAR AND TREMBLING

*Philippians 2:12-13 Wherefore, my beloved, as ye have always obeyed, not as in my presence only, but now much more in my absence, **work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.** For it is God which worketh in you both to will and to do of his good pleasure. KJV*

THIS PASSAGE OF SCRIPTURE IS SO IMPACTFUL TO THE LIFE OF EVERY BELIEVER TODAY AS IT WAS TO THE CHRISTIANS IN THE CHURCH AT PHILIPPI.

- ▼ HOWEVER, THIS PASSAGE IS TELLING US TO WORK **OUT** THE SALVATION THAT WE HAVE ALREADY RECEIVED THROUGH OUR FAITH IN CHRIST JESUS.
- ▼ IT IS NOT SAYING TO WORK **FOR** OUR SALVATION BECAUSE ALL SCRIPTURE EMPHATICALLY DECLARES THAT **NO ONE** CAN THROUGH SELF EFFORT OR EARN OR WORK TO OBTAIN THEIR SALVATION.
- ▼ SALVATION IS **NOT ABOUT US** BUT ABOUT **CHRIST AND HIS ATONING DEATH** ON THE CROSS OF CALVARY.
- ▼ WE ARE BEING ENCOURAGED TO WORK OUT THE SALVATION THAT WE HAVE ALREADY PERSONALLY EXPERIENCED THROUGH OUR FAITH IN JESUS CHRIST.
- ▼ **WE ARE TO WORK OUT WHAT IS ALREADY WITHIN US**

Philippians 2:12-13

*And now that I am away you must be even more careful **to do the good things that result from being saved,** obeying God with deep reverence, **shrinking back** from all that might **displease him.** 13 For God is at work within you, **helping you want to obey him,** and then **helping you do what he wants.** TLB*

IN FURTHER UNDERSTANDING THIS PASSAGE THERE ARE THREE IMPORTANT ASPECTS FOR US TO NOTE.

1. **RECOGNISING THAT OUR SALVATION RECEIVED FROM GOD IS THE RESULT OF OUR FAITH IN CHRIST'S ATONING DEATH ON THE CROSS.** This is past tense event and we have already experienced the full measure of his gift of salvation in our lives.
2. **ACKNOWLEDGING THAT CHRIST LIVES IN US THROUGH THE POWER OF THE HOLY SPIRIT AND** (as he does in every believer) **AND IS WORKING FROM WITHIN.**
3. **ACCEPTING THE FACT THAT GOD IS CONSTANTLY AT WORK IN US** CREATING **DESIRE** AND **POWERING** US TO **WILL** HIS WILL AND TO **WORK** HIS WORK.

Philippians 2:13 [Not in your own strength] for it is God Who is all the while effectually at work in you [energizing and creating in you the power and desire], both to will and to work for His good pleasure and satisfaction and delight. AMP

THE CHALLENGE BEFORE US ALL IS DETERMINING WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICAL TERMS, TO WORK OUT OUR OWN SALVATION.

- ▼ It is about how to translate our salvation into our daily living in the context of this present world with all its complexities and challenges.

IT MEANS

- ▼ To live out our lives in such a way that it truly reflects a changed life and honors the goodness and kindness of the God who saved us.
- ▼ It means living as a true follower of Jesus Christ honouring him with reverence / respect.

WHAT IS IT THAT GOD IS CONTINUALLY WORKING IN US

Philippians 2:13 [Not in your own strength] for it is God Who is all the while effectually at work in you [energizing and creating in you the power and desire], both to will and to work for His good pleasure and satisfaction and delight. AMP

1. **ENERGIZING US WITH POWER** and
2. **CREATING IN US DESIRE**

- ▼ **SO THAT WE WILL BOTH (together, alongside of) WILL AND WORK FOR THOSE THINGS THAT PLEASE, SATISFY AND DELIGHT GOD.**
- ▼ **GOD IS WORKING IN US** TO BRING ABOUT RECTIFICATION AND ALIGNMENT WITH HIS WILL AND ADDRESS OUR IGNORANCE OF HIS WILL OR RELUCTANCE TO FOLLOWING IT.
- ▼ **GOD SEEKS** TO BRING ABOUT CHANGE IN US SO THAT WE WILL WANT HIS WILL AND WE WANT WHAT HE WANTS.
- ▼ **BRINGING US TO A PLACE** WHERE DOING HIS WILL AND CARRYING OUT HIS WORK BECOMES SOMETHING OF A PLEASURE AND DELIGHT AND NOT JUST MERE DUTY.

GOD CREATES DESIRE

- ▼ **SO, SOME OF THOSE DESIRES WITHIN US TO DO SPECIFIC THINGS FOR GOD ARE ACTUALLY THE RESULT OF GOD HAVING CREATED OR BIRTHED THEM WITHIN.**

GOD EMPOWERS

- ▼ **SO, THE FAITH TO STEP OUT AND DO SOMETHING FOR GOD, DISREGARDING THE RISKS AND DANGERS COMES FROM GOD ENERGISING US WITH POWER.**

THIS IS WHAT GOD DOES IN US

- **GOD IS NOT ONLY WORKING IN US - BUT ALSO THROUGH US.**
- **LET US BE THAT** KIND OF PERSON WHO ACKNOWLEDGES THAT GOD IS ALL THE TIME AT WORK IN US EVEN WHEN WE CANNOT SEE THE VISIBLE EVIDENCE OF IT.
- ▼ Change and alignment is a process not a one-time event. It takes both time and endurance to address the changes needed in us because of our past ignorance of his will and often our reluctance to obey his will.
- ▼ **LET US BE** A PEOPLE THAT REALISES THAT SOME OF THOSE DESIRES AND PASSION TO CARRY OUT HIS KINGDOM WORK WITHOUT FEAR OF THE RISK AND DANGERS INVOLVED IS ALL BECAUSE GOD IS AT WORK IN US.
- **WORK OUT THOSE NEW DESIRES WITHIN AND ALSO THAT NEW PASSION TO SERVE, BECAUSE THAT IS GOD ALSO WORKING THROUGH US.**
- **WHAT A WONDERFUL TRUTH AND OPPORTUNITY** TO BE ABLE TO OUTWARDLY EXPRESS TO THE WORLD – TO OUR WORKPLACES, LEARNING INSTITUTIONS, HOMES AND FAMILIES, **ALL THAT GOD HAS BEEN WORKING WITHIN US**

Philippians 2:12-13

“... work out (cultivate, carry out to the goal, and fully complete) your own salvation with reverence and awe and trembling (self-distrust, with serious caution, tenderness of conscience, watchfulness against temptation, timidly shrinking from whatever might offend God and discredit the name of Christ).

13 [Not in your own strength] for it is God Who is all the while effectually at work in you [energizing and creating in you the power and desire], both to will and to work for His good pleasure and satisfaction and delight. AMP

Amen. Pastor Barry –